

Chapter

The Second World War

1. Name the International Organization that was formed after World War II.

SQP 2024

2. Which incident depicted in the above cartoon led to the beginning of the Second World War?



By Milton Rawson Hallday

- (a) Hitler's policy of Imperialism
- (b) Hitler's attack on Poland
- (c) Hitler's annexation of Austria
- (d) Hitler's attack on Czechoslovakia

MAIN 2024

3. Which of the following is NOT a consequence of the Second World War?

- (a) Austria and Hungary became separate states
- (b) Defeat of the Axis powers
- (c) Beginning of the Cold War
- (d) Formation of the United Nations

MAIN 2024

4. Mention any two common ideologies of Fascism and Nazism.

MAIN 2024

5. Name the two cities of Japan which were bombed by America in the year 1945.

MAIN 2024

6. Mention two reasons for the failure of the League of Nations to prevent the Second World War.

MAIN 2024

7. Name two countries each belonging to the Capitalist Bloc and Communist Bloc ?

MAIN 2023, 2024

8. State how each of the following factors were the causes of the Second World War.

(i) The failure of the League of Nations.

(ii) The Aggressive Nationalism of Germany.

(iii) The Policy of Appeasement.

MAIN 2022, 2023, 2024

9. Identify the persons given in the picture. Mention their contribution in the promotion of world peace.



MAIN 2021, 2023, 2024

10. (i) Identify the leader in the picture. What was the name given to the form of dictatorship practiced by him ?



(ii) State any two similar ideologies of the dictators.

(iii) What was the immediate cause of the Second World War ? Mention any two reasons for it.

(iv) Explain how the Japanese invasion of China became a cause for the Second World War.

MAIN 2021, 2022, 2023, 2024

11. The world wars marked a turning point in the history of the world. With reference to this period, answer the following questions:

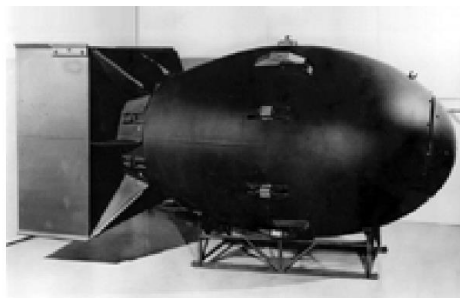
(i) Mention any three similarities between the ideologies of Fascism and Nazism.

(ii) State the three consequences of the Second World War.

(iii) Mention any four causes of the Second World War.

MAIN 2023

12. Study the picture and answer the questions :



(i) Identify the object in the picture. Which country was responsible for its production?

(ii) Where was this object used for the first time? How did it bring an end to the War?

(iii) How can a future war be avoided following the teachings of Mahatma Gandhi ?

MAIN 2023

13. What is capitalism ?

COMP 2023

14. What is meant by 'Policy of Containment' ?

COMP 2023

15. Mention three reasons for the invasion of Poland by Hitler?

COMP 2023

16. What is communism ?

SQP 2022

17. Give one reason for the origin of the Cold War.

MAIN 2022

18. What is meant by calling the world as Bipolar after the Second World War ?

MAIN 2022

19. The League of Nations was unable to eliminate power struggles leading to another World War. In this context describe how the following were connected with the Second World War.

(i) Japanese invasion of China ?

(ii) Ideological differences between nations.

(iii) Hitler's invasion of Poland.

MAIN 2022

20. Name the Allied Nations.

COMP 2022

21. What made Japan to surrender to the Allies?

MAIN 2021

Solution

1.

Ans: The United Nations Organization (UNO) was formed after World War II.

2.

Ans: (b) Hitler's attack on Poland.

Explanation:

The cartoon refers to the Danzig issue, which was used by Hitler as a pretext to invade Poland on 1 September 1939. This invasion led Britain and France to declare war on Germany, marking the beginning of the Second World War.

3.

Ans: (a) Austria and Hungary became separate states.

Explanation:

Austria and Hungary became separate states after **World War I** under the **Treaty of Versailles (1919)** and the dissolution of the Austro-Hungarian Empire — not as a consequence of the **Second World War**.

Therefore, option **(a)** is the only statement **NOT** related to the consequences of World War II.

4.

Ans:

(i) Extreme nationalism: Both Fascism and Nazism believed in the superiority of their nation and aimed at territorial expansion.

(ii) Totalitarianism: Both ideologies supported a dictatorial form of government with complete control over the state and suppression of all opposition.

5.

Ans: Hiroshima and Nagasaki.

The two Japanese cities bombed by America in 1945 were **Hiroshima** (on August 6) and **Nagasaki** (on August 9), leading to Japan's surrender and the end of World War II.

6.

Ans:

(i) Lack of Enforcement Power: The League had no military force of its own and depended on member nations to enforce its decisions. As a result, aggressive nations like Germany, Italy and Japan violated international agreements without facing effective action.

(ii) Absence of Major Powers: Important nations such as the United States did not join the League, while others like Germany and Japan eventually withdrew. This weakened the League's authority and reduced its ability to maintain peace.

7.

Ans: Two countries from the Capitalist Bloc:

(i) United States

(ii) United Kingdom

Two countries from the Communist Bloc:

(i) Soviet Union (USSR)

(ii) China

8.

Ans:

(i) Failure of the League of Nations:

The League of Nations was unable to prevent aggression because it lacked an army of its own and depended on member nations to enforce its decisions. The absence of major powers like the United States further weakened it, allowing aggressive nations such as Germany, Italy and Japan to violate international agreements without facing strong action.

(ii) Aggressive Nationalism of Germany:

Germany, under Adolf Hitler, followed a policy of aggressive nationalism aimed at expanding its territory and overturning the Treaty of Versailles. Hitler's plans to unite all German-speaking people and gain *Lebensraum* (living space) led to the annexation of Austria and the invasion of Czechoslovakia and Poland,

directly triggering the Second World War.

(iii) Policy of Appeasement:

Britain and France followed a policy of appeasement, allowing Hitler to rearm Germany, remilitarize the Rhineland, and annex Austria and Czechoslovakia. They believed that satisfying Hitler's demands would preserve peace and also prevent the spread of Communism. This encouraged Hitler to pursue further aggression, which ultimately resulted in the outbreak of the Second World War.

9.

Ans: The persons in the picture are **Mikhail Gorbachev** and **President Ronald Reagan** of the United States of America.

Contribution:

Ronald Reagan and Mikhail Gorbachev played major roles in promoting world peace during the Cold War. Their cooperation led to the signing of the **Intermediate-Range Nuclear Forces (INF) Treaty** in 1987, which significantly reduced nuclear weapons. This was the first treaty in which the superpowers agreed to eliminate an entire category of nuclear arms. It helped ease Cold War tensions and paved the way for improved relations between the USA and the Soviet Union, contributing to the eventual end of the Cold War.

10.

Ans:

(i) The leader in the picture is **Adolf Hitler**, the dictator of Germany. The form of dictatorship practiced by him was called **Nazism**.

(ii) Two similar ideologies of the dictators were:

(a) Totalitarian rule – Both believed in absolute authority of a single leader and one-party rule.

(b) Aggressive nationalism and expansionism – Both aimed to expand their territories through military conquest to revive past imperial glory.

(iii) The immediate cause of the Second World War was **Germany's invasion of Poland on September 1, 1939**.

Two reasons for this were:

(a) Germany's anger over the harsh terms of the Treaty of Versailles.

(b) Hitler's expansionist policies, including the annexation of Austria and Czechoslovakia, encouraged by the Western powers' policy of appeasement.

(iv) Japanese invasion of China:

(a) Japan invaded China in 1931 and annexed Manchuria.

(b) China appealed to the League of Nations, but the League followed a policy of appeasement.

(c) Japan withdrew from the League in 1933 and occupied foreign-owned territories in China.

(d) Japan aimed to dominate the Far East despite warnings from Western powers.

11.

Ans:

(i) Three similarities between the ideologies of Fascism and Nazism:

(a) **Extreme nationalism:** Both ideologies promoted an aggressive form of nationalism and believed in the superiority of their nation along with territorial expansion.

(b) **Dictatorship:** Both supported a totalitarian system where absolute power rested in the hands of a single leader.

(c) **Militarism and violence:** Both glorified war and military strength as a means to achieve national goals.

(ii) Three consequences of the Second World War:

(a) **Formation of the United Nations:** Established in 1945 to maintain peace and promote international cooperation.

(b) **Division of Germany:** Germany was divided into four occupation zones, eventually forming West Germany and East Germany.

(c) **Cold War:** Ideological rivalry between the USA and the Soviet Union after the war led to the Cold War.

(iii) Four causes of the Second World War:

(a) **Treaty of Versailles:** Harsh terms imposed on Germany after World War I created resentment and helped the rise of Hitler.

(b) **Expansionist policies of Axis Powers:** Germany, Italy and Japan followed aggressive expansion, increasing global tensions.

(c) **Failure of the League of Nations:** The League failed to prevent aggression and enforce peace.

(d) **Appeasement Policy:** Britain and France allowed Hitler to expand his territory, which encouraged further aggression and led to war.

12.

Ans:

(i) The object in the picture is an **atomic bomb**. It was produced by the **United States of America**.

(ii) The atomic bomb was first used on **Hiroshima, Japan**, on **August 6, 1945**, and later on **Nagasaki** on **August 9, 1945**. The massive destruction caused by these bombings forced Japan to surrender, bringing **World War II to an end**.

(iii) A future war can be avoided by following **Mahatma Gandhi's principles of non-violence (Ahimsa)**, peaceful dialogue, mutual understanding and cooperation. Gandhi emphasized resolving conflicts through peaceful means rather than violence, promoting harmony and global peace.

13.

Ans: Capitalism is a system in which the means of production are owned and controlled by private individuals rather than the government.

14.

Ans: The Policy of Containment refers to the U.S. strategy, known as the Truman Doctrine, under which the United States provided economic and military assistance to countries threatened by communist expansion. Its main aim was to stop the spread of communism and support nations at risk of falling under communist influence.

15.

Ans:

(i) The Treaty of Versailles had divided Germany into two parts to provide Poland with a land route to the sea, and the Port of Danzig was placed under Polish control. Germany wanted to recover these lost territories.

(ii) Danzig had a predominantly German population, and by occupying the Danzig Corridor, Germany could reconnect with East Prussia.

(iii) In August 1939, Germany signed a Non-Aggression Pact with Russia and accused Poland of mistreating Germans living within Polish borders, using this as a pretext for invasion.

16.

Ans: Communism is a system in which all means of production are owned and controlled by the state or the government, as seen in the USSR.

17.

Ans: One major reason for the origin of the Cold War was the deep ideological conflict between the United States and the Soviet Union—where the U.S. supported capitalism and democracy, while the USSR aimed to spread communism. This sharp ideological divide created mistrust and rivalry between the two superpowers after World War II.

18.

Ans: The world was described as **bi-polar** after the Second World War because it became divided into two powerful and opposing blocs:

- **The Capitalist (or Democratic) Bloc**, led by the **United States**
- **The Communist (or Socialist) Bloc**, led by the **USSR**

This division created two dominant centres of power influencing global politics.

19.

Ans:

(i) Japanese invasion of China:

Japan invaded Manchuria in 1931 and later attacked China in 1937. Its aim was to expand its empire and dominate the Far East. The League of Nations failed to stop Japan's aggressive actions, which increased global tensions.

(ii) Ideological differences between nations:

Democratic nations like the USA, Britain, and France believed in freedom, elections and individual rights, while countries like Germany, Italy, and Japan followed dictatorship and expansionist policies. These opposing ideologies

created mistrust and rivalry, leading to conflict.

(iii) Hitler's invasion of Poland:

Germany demanded the return of territories given to Poland under the Treaty of Versailles, especially the Danzig Corridor. On September 1, 1939, Germany invaded Poland. When Hitler refused to withdraw, Britain and France declared war on Germany, marking the beginning of the Second World War.

20.

Ans: The Allied Nations were:

(i) Britain

(ii) France

(iii) The Soviet Union

21.

Ans: Japan surrendered to the Allies on **14 August 1945** mainly because of the massive destruction caused by the **atomic bombings**.

The bombing of **Hiroshima** killed about 150,000 people and destroyed most of the city.

A second bomb was dropped on **Nagasaki**, causing around 50,000 deaths and severe destruction.

Unable to bear further devastation, Japan finally surrendered, bringing an end to **World War II**.